Unit 1 — Transition After Grade 10

Track G+M · Klasse 10 · Niveau G/M

Learning objectives I

- *I can read a short text on post-Klasse-10 paths and identify three options.*
- *I can use the third conditional (*if I had …, I would have …*).*
- *I can write a 150-word reflection on a decision I am facing.*

Lead-in I

Sam, who is back after a year abroad with his cousins, is sitting in the Klasse 10 corridor. He is reconsidering everything. Maja, who is more decisive on principle, has already chosen an apprenticeship — though she keeps reading Berufsbildung pamphlets just in case. Mr. Yilmaz says, *every Klasse 10 corridor has at least one person re-reading a leaflet they have already memorised*.

Reading I

Vocabulary — transition
apprenticeship, vocational training (Berufsausbildung), FOS/BOS (Fachoberschule / Berufsoberschule), gap year, internship, certificate, application, deadline, shortlist, interview, on-the-job training, dual system, employer reference.

Reading — *Three Paths from Maja's Class*
Three students from Maja's class chose three different paths. Lukas signed an apprenticeship contract with a local electrician. Lina applied to the FOS in Stuttgart. Adam took a gap year and wrote that a year of working as a forest ranger had changed his sense of time.

Reading II

Grammar — third conditional
Use **third conditional** for past unreal regrets / alternatives. Form: *If* + past perfect, *would have* + past participle.

- *If I had applied earlier, I would have got a place.*
- *If she had not taken the gap year, she wouldn't have met that mentor.*
- *I wouldn't have decided so fast if I had known.*

Practise I

Niveau G

1. Build the third conditional: *(if / I / apply / earlier / I / get / a place)* → ___ .
2. Match path → action: apprenticeship → contract; FOS → application; gap year → trial work.

Niveau M

3. Build 4 third-conditional sentences about a real or imagined past decision.

Your turn I

Reflection, 150 words. Write about a decision you are facing or a past one. Use 2 third conditionals + 1 second conditional + 1 *despite/because of*.

Sample

If I had been more open in Klasse 8, I would have applied to more apprenticeships. I wasn't, so I am now reading every leaflet twice. Despite the pressure of deciding, I think the right path is the FOS — partly because I want a longer track, partly because I am curious. If I were absolutely sure today, I would probably worry less. But if I had waited another six months for certainty, I would have missed the deadline. Imperfect decisions, made on time, are still real decisions. That is what I am telling myself this week.

Reflect I

- I can identify three post-Klasse-10 paths.
- I can use the third conditional with reason.
- I can write a 150-word reflection on a decision.

Further reading / listening I

- BBC Bitesize Careers — *Choices after 16*.
- Bundesagentur für Arbeit — *BERUFENET* (auf Deutsch, but accessible).